Source: Jamie Mullick, '4 charts that show India's second wave has started,' *Hindustan Times*, 12 March 2021.

Other indicators had also begun to demonstrate that the country had entered some sort of a rapidly rising wave. Positivity rate had begun to rise sharply in several districts, especially in these high caseload states; 70 districts of the country witnessed 150 per cent rise in the last few weeks.[1] At its lowest point after the first wave it was down to about 1.6 per cent, whereas now, about 2.6 per cent of all samples collected were testing positive. As a general rule, an increasing positivity rate is a good barometer to indicate that cases in that community were set to rise in the upcoming days.

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27 MARCH 2021

INDIA | 4,86,696 ACTIVE CASES | 1,62,730 DEATHS | 5.14 CRORE VACCINE DOSES

WORLD | 1,50,77,877 ACTIVE CASES | 29,11,249 DEATHS | 31.64 CRORE VACCINE DOSES

Several states had begun to make adequate preparations for the looming second wave. 'Maharashtra, and more specifically Mumbai, bore the brunt of COVID—twice,' Dr Shashank Joshi would recollect after the ebbing of the second wave. He also said how they had in March, after detection of the Delta variant, begun to plan for supplies and essentials which would be required when the wave hits. As part of this, Dr Joshi explained how Maharashtra's COVID-19 Task Force took immediate measures and carried out oxygen audits in the month of March to estimate their possible oxygen requirement and decide SOPs for oxygen outflows during treatment of COVID-19 patients. He mentioned, 'During the first wave, we faced several challenges including a shortage of oxygen. This time we wanted to ensure that rationing of oxygen and accurate estimating of requirement was carried out.' On this line of thought, just a month after they started their oxygen audit exercise, they advised hospitals in the state to discontinue using high-flow nasal oxygen (HFNO) cannula and instead turn to non-invasive ventilation while treating COVID-19 patients.[2] HFNO machines typically are guzzlers of oxygen and can use up to 80 litres of oxygen per minute.